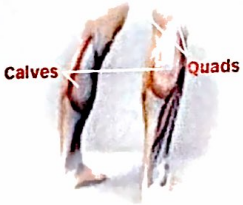
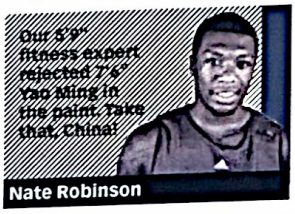
JUMP TO IT

Above the Rim

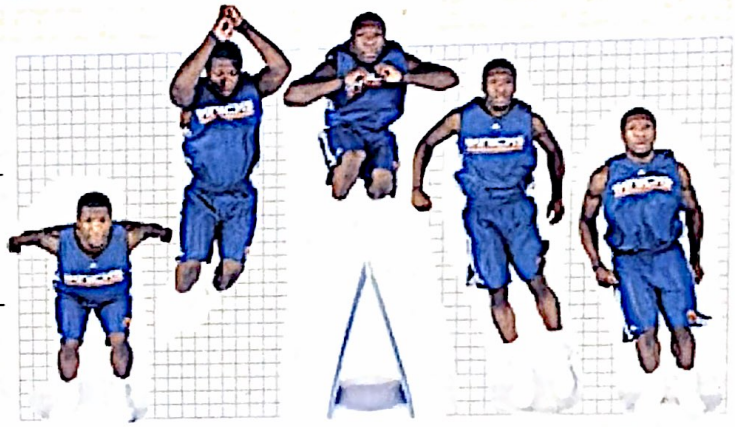
Knicks guard and 2006 Slam Dunk champ Nate Robinson boosts your ups.





Tall Barrier Jump

1. Stand next to a soft, collapsible barrier and get into a jumping stance with your feet shoulder width apart, knees bent, and elbows back. Prepare for liftoff.
2. Explode skyward using the front thirds of your feet. Float sideways and extend those ankles, knees, and hips before getting into a tight tuck.
3. Clear the barrier, reenter the stratosphere, and land in the same position from which you jumped. Be ready to leap again as soon as your feet touch.

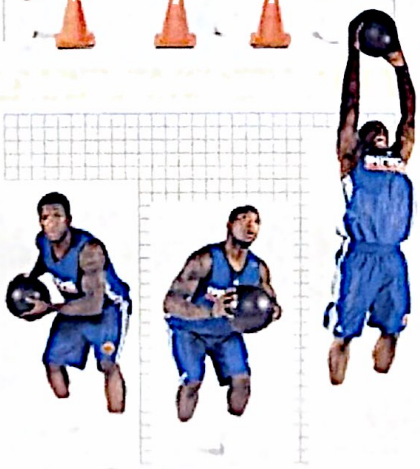


Task Complexity Jump

1. Line up a series of cones or paper bags roughly three feet away from each other. Moving laterally and keeping your knees up, start steppin'.
2. Have a friend fire you a chest pass. Keep your eyes on the ball, of course, but be hyperaware of the obstacles. Stay on your toes and continue to move sideways.
3. Chest-pass the ball right back to your friend in midstride, never missing a beat. Average one pass per cone as you dance down the line, then repeat the other way.

Medicine Ball Jump

1. Hold a 10-pound medicine ball as though you're about to dunk on your little cousin. Keep a tight core to avoid back strain. Whatever you do, don't dribble.
2. Bend your knees and bring the medicine ball down to your waist, loading both your upper and lower body for the hypothetical two-handed jam.
3. As the booster rockets kick in, raise the medicine ball as high into the air as possible. Land squarely, stabilize yourself, and go back to step one.



FIT FOOD

Flight Menu

Sustenance for soaring.

Habitual Health
"My mom always made me eat broccoli and carrots. I still do."

Smoothie Operator
"I can't eat a regular banana to save my life, so I sneak them into health shakes."

Pregame Charge
"I'll eat one right before I play for that little bit of extra energy."

Photographs, Edward Smith

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